

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #015 — Phase 1, Film 6: Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

THE MOTORTOWN REVUE

THE TEAM-UP • RELEASE: Friday, May 4, 2012

Phase 1, Film 6 (final) • The Avengers role • Motown Productions / Paramount • PG-13 • approx. 180 min (event film)

A. Release Date: Friday, May 4, 2012

The Avengers opened on Friday, May 4, 2012, the first Friday in May. The TMU takes the same date, so the team-up lands in the franchise's May slot for the fourth year running.

Schedule note: Phase 1 now ends in 2012

Memo #004 set Phase 1 at 2009–2013 and Phase 2 at 2014–2016. With the sixth film in 2012, **Phase 1 now finishes in 2012 and 2013 is empty**. Memo #004 has not been changed. You need to choose: (a) make Phase 1 officially 2009–2012 and leave 2013 as a gap year, or (b) move Phase 2 to start in 2013.

B. The Avengers Blueprint Map

The Avengers	The Motortown Revue (documented history)
Solo heroes assemble into one team	Motown's solo acts share one bill, one bus and one tour (late 1962)
Tony Stark funds and launches the team	Berry Gordy launches the tour and runs it from Hitsville
Captain America leads in the field	Smokey Robinson, Motown's first star, is the veteran on the road
Thor, the prince	Marvin Gaye, the "Prince of Motown"
Black Widow	Diana Ross, with the "no-hit" Supremes near the bottom of the bill
Nick Fury puts the team together	Esther Gordy Edwards and Motown's management operation
The team fights among itself	Every night the acts compete for applause and for their place on the bill
The alien invasion	The Jim Crow South: segregated venues, rope-divided audiences, and gunfire at the tour bus in Birmingham
"Avengers, assemble"	After the shooting, the performers choose to keep going and finish the tour together
The Battle of New York	The finale at the Apollo Theater in Harlem

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *The Motortown Revue*

It's the real name of Motown's touring show and the team name chosen in Memo #006. The film and the team share a title, just like *The Avengers*. To the public, it's a period ensemble film about a famous tour, and it gives nothing away (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Firsthand accounts from tour members, including Mary Wilson, <i>Dreamgirl</i> (1986); Martha Reeves, <i>Dancing in the Street</i> (1994); and Smokey Robinson, <i>Smokey: Inside My Life</i> (1989)	Life on the bus, the Southern dates, and the Birmingham shooting
Berry Gordy, <i>To Be Loved</i> (1994)	Why the tour was launched and how it was run from Detroit
The Motortown Revue live recordings, the tour itinerary, and period press	The roster, the running order, the venues and the dates

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: In late 1962, Motown puts every act it has on one bus and sends them into the Jim Crow South. Rivals become a family, a family becomes a team, and the team becomes the Sound of Young America.

Act One: Assemble (Detroit). Gordy's idea is to send the whole roster out together and win the country city by city. Esther and the management office put the tour together. Mary Wells is the headliner, and the Supremes are near the bottom of the bill. Marvin Gaye, the Miracles, the Marvelettes, Martha & the Vandellas and 12-year-old Little Stevie Wonder board the buses at Hitsville.

Act Two: The Road (the South). It's show after show, with competition for applause, rivalries and romances. Then comes the South: segregated hotels and restaurants, audiences divided by a rope down the middle, and in Birmingham, Alabama, gunfire at the tour bus. The team comes close to breaking apart.

Act Three: The Team (Harlem). They choose to keep going together. The tour ends at the Apollo Theater, where every act takes the stage for the finale, and they return to Detroit a family. Everyone plays at full strength (No-Nerf), from the headliner to the bottom of the bill.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

The team's: the Motortown Revue. This is the first TMU ensemble film. It's anchored by the Phase 1 leads who were really on the tour, Smokey Robinson and Marvin Gaye, with Berry Gordy launching and running it from Hitsville.

Why David Ruffin (Film 2) is not on the bus

In *The Avengers*, the Hulk is part of the team. But David Ruffin did not join the Temptations or Motown until **January 1964**, more than a year after this tour. Putting him on the 1962 bus would break the Fidelity Mandate, and **fidelity overrides the blueprint**. This isn't a nerf, because he keeps his full-strength solo film. His first team-up comes in Phase 2, once the timeline reaches his years at Motown.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	The Jim Crow South	Segregation law and custom: "whites only" facilities, rope-divided audiences, and the gunfire at the bus in Birmingham. It plays the role of the alien invasion. The film uses the system itself as the enemy and invents no single villain.
Internal	The team's rivalries	The competition for applause and top billing that the team has to get past, just as the Avengers argued among themselves on the Helicarrier.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	Late 1962, from the day the buses leave Hitsville to the final Apollo shows. Each date follows the documented itinerary.
Where	Detroit (Hitsville U.S.A.), the Northeast and the Jim Crow South (including Birmingham, Alabama), and the Apollo Theater in Harlem.
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Five. It starts the moment <i>Smokey</i> ends (the bus pulls out) and pays off the Revue poster from <i>Hitsville</i> 's end-credits scene.

7. Standalone World-Building

Life on the tour stands on its own: the buses, the dressing rooms, the theaters of the Black touring circuit, the chaperones, the young performers growing up on the road, and the South of 1962. A viewer who has seen no other TMU film can follow it as a complete historical ensemble drama (40% serialized / 60% standalone).

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in The Motortown Revue
Payoffs	The Revue poster (<i>Hitsville</i> end-credits), the Birmingham rope (<i>What's Going On</i> end-credits), and the bus departure (<i>Smokey</i> end-credits). All three pay off here.
Team formed	The Motortown Revue becomes the TMU's team (Memo #006). The Phase 1 leads and the whole roster share the screen for the first time.
Returning	Every actor from Films 1–5 who plays a tour member returns in the same role, and the Hitsville sets come back.
Seeds	The Supremes at the bottom of the bill (their rise follows in <i>Hitsville 2</i>), Little Stevie Wonder, and Martha & the Vandellas. These are future stories, visible to all.

9. Post-Credits Scenes: Two

Scene	Setting	What happens
Mid-credits	Hitsville U.S.A., early 1963	Back in Detroit, the performers line up for their tour pay. Motown's management holds their earnings and hands out allowances, as tour members' memoirs describe. The camera stays on the ledger. This plants the long-running threat of the saga: money and control, the forces that will later split the Motown family. It's the TMU's version of the Thanos reveal.
End-credits	The road home, dawn	The bus rolls back into Detroit. The whole team is asleep, slumped on each other's shoulders, and no one says a word. It pulls up at 2648 West Grand Boulevard. It's the TMU's version of the shawarma scene: the team, quiet and together.

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008). As the end of Phase 1, it closes the first chapter and sets up Phase 2.

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 1, Film 6 of 6 (final). Released May 4, 2012.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 40% serialized / 60% standalone.
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 180 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. Every returning actor is the same, all three Phase 1 post-credits setups pay off, and Ruffin is left off the 1962 tour because he wasn't there.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a period ensemble film about the real 1962 tour, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.